

Editing & Retouching

What good post-processing actually looks like

Every professional photo gets edited. The goal isn't to make it look like something it's not — it's to make it look like the best, most accurate version of what was actually there. There's a difference between editing that enhances and editing that obviously happened.

Color Correction First

Before anything else, photos in a set need to match each other. If your team headshots each have a slightly different color cast, the page looks inconsistent. Color correction makes a set of photos feel like they belong together — which they should.

Retouching That Doesn't Show

Good retouching for portraits means removing temporary things — a blemish, a bit of shine — not altering how someone actually looks. The benchmark: if you saw the before and after side by side, the edited version should look like a better day, not a different person.

Cropped for Where It's Going

A website banner, a LinkedIn headshot, and an Instagram post all need different crops. Delivering one version and expecting it to work everywhere is how you end up with a headshot where half the face is cut off. I export for each intended use case.

RAW Files vs. JPEGs

Shooting in RAW captures significantly more image data than JPEG — more latitude to fix exposure, recover highlights, and adjust color in post without degrading quality. It's more work to process but it's the difference between a photo that has room to breathe and one that doesn't.

WHAT YOU GET

Edited files are exported in web-optimized formats for site use and high-resolution versions for print — properly sized and named so they're ready to use immediately.
